so I applied for and got SF accommodation at Pratap Chowk in Delhi Cantt, as Isha needed a place to stay. During the year that I was at Mhow, Isha had applied for a course in the Trinity Laban Repertoire of Music and Dance and she had just returned from London, after spending a year there. Isha and Simon were going steady by now, and Simon had even visited us at Mhow, and the year spent apart had not diminished their friendship. Simon had by now joined the Pathways World School, Gurugram, as a dance teacher. With both Veena and I away, it was reassuring to know that there was somebody whom Isha could call on in case of emergencies. With the home front secure, I flew off to Dimapur.

At Dimapur, I was received by Col Manuhar Sharma, the Col GS, who also happened to be from the same Regiment. We drove from Dimapur to Kohima with Manuhar briefing me along the way. The Assam Rifles (AR) is a paramilitary force that comes under the MHA. Quite like the SFF, the AR too is officered by the Army and functions under its operational control, in this case under the 3 Corps located at Dimapur. The DGAR, which has its HQ in Shillong, looks after all the administrative aspects, namely the 'raise, train, sustain' functions. Under the operational control of 3 Corps were the three IGARs, North at Kohima, Nagaland; South at Imphal, Manipur; and East at Silchar, Assam. Coincidently, all three IGs—Satish Dua, myself and Rajeev Chopra—were from Lima Squadron, from three consecutive courses, 55th, 56th and 57th respectively.

Nagaland, which attained statehood in 1963, is known as the birthplace of insurgency in India and is also the longest-running insurgency. Following the Shillong Accord

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